

Tip Me Off

Team Members: *Alexander Lynn, Paul Saturno, Devraj Singh, Lucas Sossai, Mounir Ziad,*

Value: Empathy for service workers

Goal: *Tip Me Off* aims to simulate a hyper-realistic experience of working as a server in today's restaurant industry, challenging players to navigate difficult customer interactions while tempted with the option of being snarky to guests

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Introduction:

Tip Me off is a narrative driven simulation game. Players assume the role of a restaurant server managing tables during a chaotic shift. Through branching dialogue and choices, players balance speed, pressure, and politeness while interacting with a wide variety of guests. But there is a catch. There is always the option of being rude to guests and letting your innermost thoughts get the best of you. Not only is this suggested, but it is encouraged, but only for guests that deserve it. Players should analyze each guest's interaction and respond appropriately. Each decision impacts customer satisfaction and ultimately determines the tip received after service is provided. Tip Me Off explores themes found in the service industry such as patience and social interaction. With multiple outcomes per guest experience, Tip Me Off challenges players to navigate difficult situations while maximizing their tips.

Design Pillars

1 - Rudeness Must Have Consequences

- Players should always have the option to be rude, but just like real life, actions have must consequences
- Consequences come in the form of unique customer reactions and players tips (\$\$\$) being affected because of their attitude

2 - Believable Restaurant Scenarios

- The restaurant operation and guest interactions should strive to simulate a real dining experience
- Guest complaints and requests should be created from personal experience if possible

3 - Comedy Through Social Tension

- The dialogue options, guest interactions, and consequences should be humorous rather than serious
- Sarcasm and blunt responses should drive the interactions with guests

4 - Customer Personality Drives Gameplay

- Every customer should have a unique identity and behaviors that can affect the players' attitude towards them
- Customers should come from all different backgrounds to diversify the experience

Concept:

Tip Me Off is an interactive narrative where the player works as a restaurant server trying to balance good service with maintaining composure. The player will experience both the good and the bad of food service, and it is up to them how they want to navigate each shift. Players must respond to customer requests, handle difficult situations, and make quick decisions that affect service quality, and ultimately their income. Tip Me Off emphasizes choice driven dialogue so that the player always experiences the consequences to their actions.

Genre:

Narrative Simulation/Choice based interactive story

Setting:

Tip Me Off takes place in a modern casual dining restaurant during a dinner shift on a Saturday night

Target Audience:

- College students and young adults
- People familiar with the restaurant/service industry
- People who enjoy narrative games and interactive fiction
- People who enjoy sarcasm and witty humor

Look and Feel

Since the game is being built in Twine, the text-driven game will be minimalistic, with color and effects as needed. The focus is on clear, readable fonts, short spurts of dialogue so each scenario is digestible and does not drag on.

Color Palette: Colors that resemble restaurant interiors such as deeper reds, browns, and white

Narrative and Theme:

The narrative focuses on the experience of working in the service industry. Themes include:

- Customer behavior
- Patience
- Workplace stress
- Unpredictability

Technical Aspects:

- Short spurts of dialogue
- Dialogue choices that branch the narrative of that guest experience
- Variables tracking tip amount and customer satisfaction

The game is built in Twine; no physical components needed

Player Objectives:

The main objective of the player is to earn the most money possible during the shift. Players accomplish this by:

- Correctly analyzing each guest interaction and responding accordingly
- Making the correct dialogue choices for the given situation
- Managing difficult guests
- Avoiding mistakes that could lower guest satisfaction

Possible outcomes include:

1. Large tip
2. Average tip
3. Small tip
4. No tip
5. Complaint to manager + no tip

Mechanics:

Core gameplay mechanics include:

- Choice based dialogue – players choose how to respond to guests, which changes the outcome of the interaction
- Customer satisfaction – each decision made increases or decreases customer satisfaction
- Tip system – customer satisfaction and some randomness determine how much the customer will tip at the end of their dining experience

Characters/NPCs:

The Server (Player):

The player takes on the role of a restaurant server during a busy shift. The player is a young adults/college student trying to make a living while still in school

Overall Sketch:

TIP ME OFF

Customer: "Hi, can we start with waters?"

You are serving Table 12 during a busy shift.

> Sure! I'll bring those right away.
> Of course! Can I start you with drinks too?
> You'll get them when I get them.

Table Satisfaction: 7/10 Current Tip: \$0

Detail Sketch:

TIP TRACKER

 CURRENT TIPS

\$18.50

Table 3	+\$6.00
Table 7	+\$4.50
Table 12	+\$8.00

Shift Goal: \$50

Team Members and Roles:

Paul Saturno: Game Designer, Project Manager

Lucas Sossai: Creative Writer

Devraj Singh: Creative Writer

Alexander Lynn: Illustrator, UI Designer, Lead Playtester

Mounir Ziad: Programmer

Updated Schedule (5 weeks):

Sprint 1

Sprint Dates: March 30 – April 6

Team Member	Role(s)	Contributions
Paul	Game Designer, Project Manager	Assign tasks, roles, and deadlines for the team
Lucas	Creative Writer	Begin brainstorming scenarios for interactions
Dev	Creative Writer	Begin brainstorming scenarios for interactions
Alex	Illustrator, UI Designer, Lead Playtester	Begin designing the games UI
Mounir	Programmer	Gain familiarity with Twine

Table continues below

Sprint 2

Sprint Dates: April 7 – April 12

Team Member	Role(s)	Contributions
Paul	Game Designer, Project Manager	Assign tasks, roles, and deadlines for the team. Assist with dialogue and general design choices and programming
Lucas	Creative Writer	Begin fleshing out “rude” guest scenarios and interactions
Dev	Creative Writer	Begin fleshing out “kind” guest scenarios and interactions
Alex	Illustrator, UI Designer, Lead Playtester	Finish UI mockups for text and tips
Mounir	Programmer	Begin setting up dialogue system

Sprint 3

Sprint Dates: April 13 – April 19

Team Member	Role(s)	Contributions
Paul	Game Designer, Project Manager	Assign tasks, roles, and deadlines for the team. Assist with dialogue and general design choices and programming
Lucas	Creative Writer	Finalize all “rude” guest scenarios and interactions
Dev	Creative Writer	Finalize all “kind” guest scenarios and interactions
Alex	Illustrator, UI Designer, Lead Playtester	Begin implementing UI into the game
Mounir	Programmer	Implement dialogue system and start working on tips system

Sprint 4

Sprint Dates: April 20 – April 26

Team Member	Role(s)	Contributions
Paul	Game Designer, Project Manager	Assign tasks, roles, and deadlines for the team. Assist with dialogue and general design choices and programming. Being conducting internal playtesting
Lucas	Creative Writer	Test out “rude” scenarios and add/change/remove dialogue as needed
Dev	Creative Writer	Test out “kind” scenarios and add/change/remove dialogue as needed
Alex	Illustrator, UI Designer, Lead Playtester	Adjust UI as needed
Mounir	Programmer	Fully implement both dialogue and tips system in the game

Sprint 5

Sprint Dates: April 27 – Final

Team Member	Role(s)	Contributions
Paul	Game Designer, Project Manager	Assign tasks, roles, and deadlines for the team. Assist with dialogue and general design choices and programming. Final round of testing and iteration
Lucas	Creative Writer	Finalize and tweak “rude” scenarios
Dev	Creative Writer	Finalize and tweak “kind” scenarios
Alex	Illustrator, UI Designer, Lead Playtester	Make final tweaks to UI based on testing and feedback
Mounir	Programmer	Bug fixes and final tweaks/implementations

